So, in the end, how do we choose between lists and queues?

Well, we need to reason a bit more about our design, so far we have only considered the hash table and the linked list separately, but we need to make them work together in synchrony.

We might store very large objects in the cache, and we definitely don’t want to duplicate them in both data structures. One way to avoid duplication is storing the entries only in one of the structures, and referencing them from the other one: we could either add the entries to the hash table and store in the other DS the key to the hash table, or vice versa.

Both linked lists and queues could support either way. But we are going to use a linked list instead: the reason is going to be clear in a few lines.

We also need, in fact, to decide which data structure should hold the values and which one should be left with the reference: here, we are arguing that the best choice is having hash table entries store pointers to linked list nodes, and have the latter store the actual values, and the main reason for that is the same for choosing lists over queues[20].